



Sales/marketing

Promotes and sells existing products and services and plans new ones.

Finance

Takes responsibility for money in and out of the business, produces financial reports; develops financial plans.

Customer services

Plans, provides, and promotes excellent customer service; sets service standards.

Information technology

Plans, implements, and maintains technology infrastructure; develops data management and communication strategies.



MAKING IT WORK

Over time, management structures can be changed to suit the needs of the business. A function-based structure (see left) is widely used, but here are others to consider:

- **Team structure** suits businesses that need rapid responses to problems, although it can be hard to maintain overall control.
- **Network structure** is "flat" (nonhierarchical), decentralized, and flexible. Its agility suits creative and technology companies; its low overheads are appealing to start-ups.

"Never doubt that a small group of committed people can change the world."

Margaret Mead, US cultural anthropologist